Cherif Rahman

Cloud Security & Automation Student | AWS | Infrastructure as Code
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SUMMARY

Cloud and security student with hands-on cloud engineering on AWS: Infrastructure as Code (IaC) with CloudFormation, continuous integration and delivery (CI/CD) with GitHub Actions, and Python scripting for auto-remediation. Built an IAM compliance triage engine; retesting after remediation showed open findings drop from 4 to 0. Trained through Tolles AI and Cloud Development and Columbus State information technology coursework.

SKILLS

AWS & Automation: Cloud Computing, Amazon Web Services (AWS), AWS CloudFormation, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), CI/CD, GitHub Actions, AWS Lambda, Python, Amazon EventBridge, Amazon SNS, Amazon S3, AWS Organizations (SCPs)
Cloud Security: AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM), IAM Access Analyzer, AWS CloudTrail, AWS Config, AWS Security Hub, Amazon GuardDuty, Security Groups, CIS Benchmarks, Least Privilege, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Security Compliance, Governance, Vulnerability Identification
Data & Databases: SQL, SQL Server (SSMS), DuckDB, ER Diagrams, Normalization
Systems & Tools: Network Fundamentals, Windows, Troubleshooting, Git, GitHub, cfn-lint, Checkov, pytest

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | Amazon Web Services | Pending

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) | Amazon Web Services | Pending

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | Microsoft | In progress

CompTIA Cloud+ | CompTIA | In progress

PCEP – Certified Entry-Level Python Programmer | Python Institute | In progress, expected Nov 2026

PROJECTS

Automated AWS Security Baseline | github.com/mrcrahman/policyholder-security-baseline | Oct 2026

- Deployed an AWS CloudFormation security baseline to us-east-2 via Git sync, with a GitHub Actions cfn-lint IaC security gate on every push and multi-region CloudTrail with log file validation and SNS email alerts.
- Enforced S3 Block Public Access, an SCP, a CloudTrail tamper alert, EventBridge + Lambda S3 auto-remediation, and 2 AWS Config managed rules; Config flagged a test world-open SSH rule as noncompliant.

AWS IAM Compliance Triage Engine | github.com/mrcrahman/aws-iam-compliance-triage | Oct 2026

- Built SQL queries in DuckDB that audit AWS IAM credential reports for 3 high-risk conditions: root access keys (Security Hub IAM.4), users without MFA (IAM.5), and access keys older than 90 days (IAM.3).
- Prioritized and documented findings with a severity ranking to surface the highest-risk identity issues.
- Retested after remediation with before-and-after evidence, reducing open findings from 4 to 0.

Least-Privilege AWS Access Simulation | AWS IAM

- Designed and validated least-privilege AWS IAM permissions limited to what a defined task required.

EDUCATION

Columbus State Community College | Columbus, OH | College Credit Plus (dual enrollment) | Expected May 2029
Associate of Applied Science (AAS), Computer Science – Cybersecurity Major. Coursework: CSCI-1320 Database Fundamentals (SQL Server, SSMS, ER diagrams, normalization)

Tolles Career & Technical Center | Plain City, OH | Expected May 2027
Cybersecurity (Year 1) and Senior AI & Cloud Development. Coursework: Network Fundamentals, Cybersecurity Principles

Hilliard Bradley High School | Hilliard, OH | Expected May 2027
High School Diploma, General Education

EXPERIENCE

SkillsUSA | Member | Sep 2024 – Present

- Built leadership, teamwork, and communication skills collaborating with peers on technical projects.

My Very Own Blanket | Volunteer

- Partnered with a team of volunteers to support children in need through a nonprofit.